

Argument 1

Assertion

Overall national decline is the result of the failure of the state and its institutions.

Reasoning

A modern state functions through different institutions with different responsibilities. In the traditional separation of powers, the **legislature makes laws, the executive implements those laws, and the judiciary interprets and applies the law while holding violations accountable.**

These branches are not independent islands. They form one system through which the state governs society.

Therefore, when these institutions function properly, the state can maintain order, enforce rules, protect rights, and provide public services. But when these institutions begin to fail through corruption, abuse of power, weak enforcement, or lack of accountability, the failure is not restricted to one office or one individual.

It becomes a **state-level failure.**

And because the state is responsible for maintaining the political, economic, legal, and institutional foundations of society, persistent institutional failure eventually produces wider national deterioration.

Example

The World Bank identifies governance and institutional quality as central to development outcomes. Its justice-and-rule-of-law work states that effective justice institutions increase accountability, restrain abuse of power, curb corruption, strengthen trust, and support investment, economic growth, and public-service delivery. ([World Bank](#))

Linking

Therefore, **national decline is not produced only by problems in individual sectors; it emerges when the institutions responsible for governing those sectors fail.**

And this brings us to the most important question:

Among these institutions, which one is capable of holding the others accountable?

That takes us directly to our second claim.

Argument 2

Assertion

Corruption in the judiciary weakens the accountability mechanism of the state and can therefore become a primary driver of national decline.

Reasoning

The legislature can create laws.

The executive can implement laws.

But neither fact alone guarantees that those powers will be exercised properly.

There must be an institution capable of determining whether laws and government powers are being exercised according to the legal framework, resolving violations, and providing accountability.

That is why the judiciary is so important.

When the judiciary is independent and effective, violations by powerful individuals and institutions can be challenged and punished through lawful processes. But when the judiciary itself becomes corrupt, accountability becomes weaker.

Then the problem is no longer simply:

“There is corruption inside the judiciary.”

The deeper problem becomes:

“Who will effectively hold corrupt actors in the rest of the system accountable?”

This is why judicial corruption can have a wider systemic effect. The World Bank describes justice institutions as being on the frontline of anticorruption enforcement and notes that corruption thrives where justice systems are weak. It also identifies justice institutions as providing checks and balances on abuse of power by the executive and legislature. ([World Bank](#))

Example

The World Bank states that effective justice institutions can increase accountability, curb corruption, restrain abuse of power, and create conditions for stronger public services and economic growth. It therefore treats justice institutions as foundational to the relationship between citizens and the state. ([World Bank](#))

Linking

So, corruption in education damages education; corruption in the judiciary can weaken the mechanism that is supposed to control corruption throughout the state.

If accountability becomes weak, corruption in other institutions can survive for longer, institutional failure can spread, and the combined result can be national decline.

Therefore, our first two arguments establish:

State failure produces national decline, and judicial corruption can accelerate that state failure by weakening the accountability mechanism of the entire system.

Now we compare this with the education sector.

Argument 3

Assertion

Education-sector corruption is a cause of national decline, but it does not have the same systemic reach as judicial corruption.

Reasoning

Let us accept the strongest possible case for the Government.

Suppose a student receives education from the education system. That education may develop knowledge, technical ability, and professional capacity.

But then what?

That student eventually has to **enter the job market, work in an institution, build a business, become a professional, or contribute to the public sector.**

If those institutions are corrupted, merit is not rewarded properly, opportunities can be distorted, and capable people may struggle to use the abilities they developed.

This creates a very important distinction:

Education can create human capital, but institutions determine whether that human capital can actually be used productively.

Bangladesh itself demonstrates the importance of this transition from education to employment. The World Bank notes significant employment challenges for young people and reports that many higher-education graduates struggle to secure suitable employment. ([World Bank Blogs](#))

So imagine the extreme case:

A Bangladeshi student receives years of education and the country invests resources in developing that person's knowledge and skills. But when that person enters the domestic employment environment, the system does not provide fair or effective opportunities to use those abilities.

Then the value created by the education system is not fully captured by Bangladesh.

In some cases, people may seek opportunities abroad. International migration is already a major component of Bangladesh's labour market, with millions of Bangladeshi nationals living overseas. ([DTM](#))

So the concern you raised can be framed as:

We invest in developing human capital, but if the wider institutional and economic environment cannot productively absorb that human capital, the benefit to the country is reduced.

Example

UNESCO confirms that corruption in education can distort resources and opportunities, reduce access to quality education, and damage learning. So there is no doubt that education corruption is harmful. ([UNESCO](#))

But the World Bank simultaneously identifies effective justice institutions as having effects that extend beyond one sector: accountability, corruption control, public services, investment, business confidence, and economic growth. ([World Bank](#))

Linking

Therefore, the question is not:

“Does education corruption cause national decline?”

Yes, it does.

The real question is:

“Is it the primary driving force?”

And our answer is **no**.

Education corruption damages one crucial pipeline of national development. But a corrupted accountability and justice system can allow failures across **many pipelines** to persist.

So when we compare their systemic reach, **judicial corruption has the stronger claim to being a primary driver.**

Conclusion

Honourable moderator, my dear opponents,

The Government wants you to believe that because corruption exists in education, **education corruption must therefore be the primary driving force behind national decline.**

But that confuses **a cause** with **the primary cause**.

We have shown three things.

First, national decline ultimately reflects the failure of the institutions through which the state functions.

Second, the judiciary is a central accountability mechanism of that state. When corruption enters the judiciary, the ability of the system to control abuse and corruption elsewhere can also be weakened. ([World Bank](#))

Third, education corruption is undoubtedly harmful. It can damage educational resources, opportunities, and learning. ([UNESCO](#)) But education is only one part of the national system. The human capital it creates still needs functioning institutions, fair economic opportunities, and effective rule of law to translate into national development.

Therefore, **education corruption is a contributor to national decline, but it is not the primary driving force.**

The deeper issue is whether the **state's accountability mechanisms are functioning.**

Because when the institution that is supposed to hold the system accountable becomes corrupt, corruption elsewhere becomes harder to control.

And that is why, **on comparative systemic impact, corruption in the judiciary is the stronger candidate for the primary driving force behind a nation's overall decline.**